# TORTELLI DI ZUCCA

| REGION | SERVES | TOTAL TIME |
|---|---|---|
| **North** | **4-6** | **3 h plus the squash drain and the dough rest** |

## INGREDIENTS

| | |
|---|---|
| **900 g** | Delicata squash |
| **900 g** | Butternut squash |
| **60 g** | Unsalted butter for the squash cavities, cold and cubed |
| **quantity not given** | Salt |
| **quantity not given** | Black pepper |
| **42 g** | Olive oil |
| **3 sprigs** | Rosemary |
| **5 sprigs** | Thyme |
| **40 g** | Garlic |
| **232 g** | Ricotta |
| **30 g** | Apple or pear mostarda, finely chopped |
| **90 g** | Parmigiano-reggiano for the filling, finely grated |
| **quantity not given** | Nutmeg, whole |
| **1 batch** | Egg dough |
| **114 g** | Unsalted butter for the sauce, cold and cubed |
| **10** | Sage leaves, small |
| **30 g** | Parmigiano-reggiano to finish, finely grated |
| **15 g** | Amaretti cookies, finely crushed |

## METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Halve both squashes lengthwise and scrape out the seeds and fibers.
3. Set the halves on a sheet pan, hollow side up, and divide the 60 g of butter between the cavities. Season with salt and pepper. Drizzle the olive oil over, then strew the rosemary, thyme and garlic around them.
4. Roast 45 minutes to 1 hour, until a fork slides in easily.
5. Let the squash cool. Pull out the garlic and herbs and throw them away.
6. Scoop the flesh out of the skins and discard the skins. You are after about 450 g of flesh.
7. Stand a cheesecloth-lined chinois or fine-mesh strainer over a bowl. Spoon the flesh in, lay parchment or plastic wrap directly on the surface and press it down under a plate. The parchment is there so the squash does not stick to the plate. Refrigerate at least 2 hours, or overnight, and let the liquid seep out.
8. Pass the drained squash through a tamis or fine-mesh strainer into a bowl.
9. Pulse the ricotta in a food processor only until it turns as smooth as cake frosting, with a sheen on it. Stop there, because longer will break it. Add it to the squash.
10. Mix in the mostarda and the 90 g of parmigiano. Season with salt and pepper and about 15 gratings of nutmeg, no more, since the spice blooms once it is cooked. It should taste well seasoned. Refrigerate until you need it.
11. Form 60 tortelli from the egg dough and the filling.
12. Bring a large pot of water to the boil over high heat and salt it heavily.
13. In a small saucepan over medium heat, cook 60 g of the sauce butter 3 to 4 minutes, to just past golden brown. Drop a few sage leaves in to infuse lightly, then pull it off the heat. This gets drizzled over the plated pasta.
14. Add the tortelli to the pot and turn the heat down so the water holds a gentle simmer rather than a rolling boil. Give them 3 to 5 minutes. They are done when the thickest closure point is tender.
15. While they cook, set a large saute pan over low heat with 1 to 2 ladles of the pasta water, 55 to 115 g. Add the remaining butter and swirl to emulsify.
16. Lift the tortelli over with a spider and raise the heat to medium. Swirl 1 to 2 minutes to marry pasta and sauce, turning each piece with a spoon so every side gets coated. A splash more cooking water loosens the sauce if it tightens.
17. Divide into bowls and drizzle the reserved sage brown butter over. Finish with the 30 g of parmigiano, the crushed amaretti, the remaining sage, and grated nutmeg and pepper.

## NOTES

Cook these at a simmer, never at a boil. The filling is delicate and a hard boil breaks it out through the closure.
Draining the roasted flesh under a weight for at least 2 hours is what keeps the filling from going watery and loose.
Quince mostarda is the Mantuan original. Apple or pear mostarda stands in for it.
The amaretti are a garnish here rather than a filling ingredient, which keeps the sweetness in check.
15 g of crushed amaretti is about 2 large cookies.

FILLING

## Squash and Mostarda Filling

### INGREDIENTS

| | |
|---|---|
| **900 g** | Delicata squash |
| **900 g** | Butternut squash |
| **60 g** | Unsalted butter, cold and cubed |
| **quantity not given** | Salt |
| **quantity not given** | Black pepper |
| **42 g** | Olive oil |
| **3 sprigs** | Rosemary |
| **5 sprigs** | Thyme |
| **40 g** | Garlic |
| **232 g** | Ricotta |
| **30 g** | Apple or pear mostarda, finely chopped |
| **90 g** | Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated |
| **quantity not given** | Nutmeg, whole |

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9. Pulse the ricotta in a food processor only until it turns as smooth as cake frosting, with a sheen on it. Stop there, because longer will break it. Add it to the squash.
10. Mix in the mostarda and the parmigiano. Season with salt and pepper and about 15 gratings of nutmeg. It should taste well seasoned. Refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

### NOTES

900 g each of delicata and butternut gives about 450 g of roasted flesh once the skins and seeds are out.
The 2-hour weighted drain is the step that decides the texture. Skip it and the filling is watery and too loose to hold a seal.
Delicata mixed with a smaller measure of butternut or Honeynut keeps the filling from turning too sweet. Capel da Pret, the gray-skinned pumpkin grown around Mantua, is firmer and carries less sugar than the pumpkins sold in the US, so pumpkin is not a straight swap.
Hold the nutmeg at about 15 gratings. The spice blooms as the pasta cooks.
Quince mostarda is traditional. Apple or pear mostarda replaces it. Mustard extract, which gives the original its pungency, is banned as a foodstuff in the United States because its erucic acid content can be toxic.

SHAPE

# Tortelli

*Region: Across Italy, particularly Emilia-Romagna and Lombardy / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator*

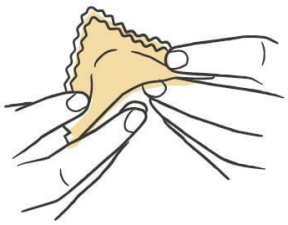
**METHOD**

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Line a sheet pan with parchment and dust it with semolina.
3. Lay one sheet out. Cut it into 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted dough divider. A fluted pastry cutter with a ruler, or a knife with a ruler, works too. Keep the squares under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Load the filling into a pastry bag cut to a 1/2-inch opening. Pipe a quarter-sized dab of filling into the middle of each square.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist the squares with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the work surface. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Hold a square in your palm and fold one corner across toward its opposite, stopping a little short of the far edge so the two ruffled edges sit tiered rather than flush.
7. Pinch the edges shut around the filling with thumb and index finger. Work back and forth a few times and push all the air out.
8. Press a dimple into the center of the filled side with your index finger.
9. Hold both ends of the triangle with the dimple facing you, bring the ends together, and cross them over each other very slightly so the piece takes a canoe shape with the filling in the middle. Pinch the ends closed firmly.
10. Set the piece on the prepared pan. Fill and fold the rest of the squares, keeping them in a single layer, and dust the pan again with semolina.
11. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
12. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

**SHAPING**



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**NOTES**

Sheet is cut into 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted dough divider, so the edges are ruffled.
Filling per piece: a quarter-sized circle piped through a 1/2-inch opening.
The fold deliberately stops short of the far corner, landing a little below it, so the two fluted edges tier instead of lining up. That offset is part of the look.
Seal geometry: fold corner to corner into a triangle, pinch the edges, dimple the filled side, then bring the two ends together and cross them slightly into a canoe or boat. Crossing the ends in front, rather than closing them into a ring underneath, is the difference from tortellini.
Air must be forced out of the edges as you pinch.
This step list omits the 00 flour dusting of the work surface that the other shapes call for. Only the sheet pan gets prepared.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Filled with squash flavored with mostarda, or with cheese and greens and sauced with restraint. Close cousin of cappellacci di zucca from Ferrara.

DOUGH

## Egg Dough

*Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped*

**INGREDIENTS**

| | |
|---|---|
| **500 g** | Tipo 00 flour |
| **454 g** | Egg yolks |
| **as needed** | Extra 00 flour for kneading |
| **up to 1 tbsp, only if dry** | Room-temperature water |

**METHOD**

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

**NOTES**

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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